F4D1 – ANALYSIS AND GEOMETRY ON MANIFOLDS
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Preliminaries

These notes roughly correspond to the course **F4D1 – Analysis and Geometry on Manifolds** taught by Prof. Laurent Côté at the Universität Bonn in the Winter 2024/25 semester. These notes are LaTeX-ed after the fact with significant alteration and are subject to misinterpretation and mistranscription. Use with caution. Any errors are undoubtedly my own and any virtues that could be ascribed to these notes ought be attributed to the instructor and not the typist.

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We first set the following conventions to be used throughout these notes:

- Let X be a topological space. A neighborhood of a point $p \in X$ is an open set $U \subseteq X$ containing p.
- For $p = (p_1, \ldots, p_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $r \in \mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$, $B_r(p) = \{x \in \mathbb{R}^n : |x - p|^2 < r\}$ is the open ball of radius r centered at p.

We begin with a review of point set topology.

Recall the definition of locally Euclidean spaces.

Definition 1.1 (Locally Euclidean Space)**.** Let X be a topological space. X is locally euclidean if each point $x \in X$ has a neighborhood homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^n$ for some fixed n.

Remark 1.2. Note that the definition above does not permit topological spaces with points $x, y \in X$ such that x admits a neighborhood homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^n$ and y admits a neighborhood homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^m$ for $m \neq n$.

On a locally Euclidean topological space, we can take the neighborhoods homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^n$ and consider open subsets of such neighborhoods which also possess a map to $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Definition 1.3 (Chart)**.** Let X be a locally Euclidean topological space. A chart (U, ϕ) consists of an open set $U \subseteq X$ and a continuous map $\phi : U \to \mathbb{R}^n$ that is a homeomorphism onto its image.

Given a point $x \in X$ and a neighborhood, we can consider charts with a prescribed image $\phi(x) \in \mathbb{R}^n$. An especially nice case is when $\phi(x) = 0 \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

Definition 1.4 (Centered Chart)**.** Let X be a locally Euclidean topological space. A chart (U, ϕ) is centered at $x \in U$ if $\phi(x) = 0 \in \mathbb{R}^n$.

In fact, one can show that locally Euclidean topological spaces have charts centered at x for all points $x \in X$.

Proposition 1.5. Let X be a topological space. The following are equivalent:

(a) X is locally Euclidean.
(b) For any point $x \in X$, there is a chart centered at x with image the unit ball of $\mathbb{R}^n$.
(c) For any point $x \in X$, there is a chart centered at x with image $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Proof. (b)$\Longleftrightarrow$(c) by composing appropriately with the homeomorphism $B_1(0) \to \mathbb{R}^n$ by fixing the origin and the map on the complement defined by $x \mapsto \frac{1}{1-\|x\|}$. Furthermore (c)$\Rightarrow$(a) since (c) is a homeomorphisms of a neighborhood to $\mathbb{R}^n$ are in particular continuous maps to $\mathbb{R}^n$ homeomorphic onto its image.

It remains to show (a)$\Rightarrow$(b). Consider a chart (U, ϕ). For $x \in U$, we can consider the map $U \to \mathbb{R}^n$ by $y \mapsto y - \phi(x)$ yielding a chart centered at x. By scaling this map by some $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}_{>0}$ we can consider a map $\widetilde{\phi}$ by $y \mapsto \lambda y - \lambda\phi(x)$ with image containing $B_1(0)$. Restriction to the preimage of $B_1(0)$ under $\widetilde{\phi}$ yields a chart centered at x with image the unit ball $(U|_{\widetilde{\phi}^{-1}(B_1(0))}, \widetilde{\phi})$. ∎

We now introduce the notion of Hausdorff spaces, which include the spaces of concern in this course, as well as a large proportion of spaces one will encounter over the course of one's mathematical life.

Definition 1.6 (Hausdorff)**.** Let X be a topological space. X is Hausdorff if for any two distinct points $x, x' \in X$ there exist open neighborhoods U, U' of x, x', respectively, such that $U \cap U' = \emptyset$.

Example 1.7. Euclidean space $\mathbb{R}^n$ is Hausdorff.

Example 1.8. CW complexes are Hausdorff.

Example 1.9. Let X be the topological space given by the set $\{0, 1\}$ and open sets $\emptyset, \{0\}, \{0, 1\}$. This space is not Hausdorff since the points 0 and 1 cannot be separated by open sets. This space is in fact the quotient space $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{R}^\times$ with $\mathbb{R}^\times$ acting on $\mathbb{R}$ by multiplication.

Remark 1.10. As suggested by Example 1.9, quotient spaces are the prototypical example of non-Hausdorff spaces.

We can show the following properties of Hausdorff spaces.

Proposition 1.11. Let X be a Hausdorff topological space. Then:

(i) Compact sequences have unique limits.
(ii) Compact subsets are closed.
(iii) One-point subsets are closed.

Proof of (a). Suppose to the contrary that there is a sequence $\{x_i\}_{i=1}^\infty$ with limit points x, x' distinct. Since X is Hausdorff, we can take open neighborhoods U, U' of x, x', respectively, such that $U \cap U' = \emptyset$. However we can take N large we have both $x_i \in U$ and $x_i \in V$, a contradiction as U, U' are disjoint. ■

Proof of (b). Let $K \subseteq X$ be compact. We want to show that its complement $X \setminus K$ is open. Let $x \in X \setminus K$. Since X is Hausdorff, we can consider a neighborhood V_y for each $y \in K$ disjoint from (possibly varying) neighborhoods U_y of x. Since K is compact, K is covered by finitely many V_y's say $V_{y_1}, \ldots, V_{y_n}$ and set $U = \bigcap_{i=1}^n U_{y_i}$. Note that each U_{y_i} is an open set of X containing x in the complement of V_{y_i} in X and as such their intersection contains x and is in the complement of K. As such, any $x \in X \setminus K$ admits an open neighborhood disjoint from K showing K is closed. ■

Proof of (c). This is immediate from (b), for one-point sets are compact. ■

We now discuss bases and covers of topological spaces.

Definition 1.12 (Basis for a Topological Space)**.** Let X be a topological space. A collection $\mathcal{B}$ of arbitrary subsets of X is a basis of X if for any $p \in X$ and any neighborhood U of p there exists an element of B containing p and contained in U.

It can be shown that any open set of a topological space can be written as a union of basis sets.

Proposition 1.13. Let X be a topological space and $\mathcal{B}$ an arbitrary collection of subsets of X. $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis of X if and only if every open set of X can be written as a union of sets of $\mathcal{B}$.

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) Suppose $\mathcal{B}$ is a basis of X and let $U \subseteq X$ be open. For $x \in U$ consider $V_x \in \mathcal{B}$ containing x but contained in U where we have $U = \bigcup_{x \in U} V_x$, writing U as a union of basis sets.

($\Leftarrow$) Suppose for each open $U \subseteq X$ we can write $U = \bigcup_{i \in I} V_i$. As such, for each point $x \in U$ there is some V_i contained in U containing X thus forming a basis. ■

We want to focus our attention on topological spaces that are appropriately "small" by imposing size conditions on the basis.

Definition 1.14 (Second Countable Space)**.** Let X be a topological space. X is a second countable space if X admits a countable basis $\mathcal{B}$.

The countability property is preserved under the following conditions.

Proposition 1.15. Let X be a topological space. Then:

(i) If X is second countable, then any subspace of X with the subspace topology is second countable.
(ii) If $\{U_i\}_{i \in I}$ is a countable open cover of X with each each U_i second countable then X is countable.
(iii) If X is locally Euclidean and $\{K_i\}_{i=1}^{\infty}$ is a sequence of compact subsets such that $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} K_i$ then X is second countable.

Remark 1.16. The property of being second countable is not preserved under arbitrary quotients, though this holds when the quotient map is open.

We can describe the second countability property in terms of covers.

Proposition 1.17. Let X be a topological space. If X is second countable then any open cover of X admits a countable subcover.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a countable basis for X and $\{U_i\}_{i \in I}$ an open cover of X. Consider $\widetilde{\mathcal{B}}$ consisting of those basis elements of X contained in some U_i. Note that $\widetilde{\mathcal{B}}$ is a cover of X since for any point $x \in U_i$ there is an element of $\mathcal{B}$ containing x contained in U_i. For each $V \in \widetilde{\mathcal{B}}$ of which there are countably many, consider $U_V \in \{U_i\}_{i \in I}$ such that $V \subseteq U_V$ these form a cover of X indexed by a countable set $\widetilde{\mathcal{B}}$ giving the claim. ■

We also introduce the following notion of compact exhaustability.

Definition 1.18 (Compact Exhaustability)**.** Let X be a topological space. X is compactly exhaustible if there exists a sequence of compact subsets $\{K_i\}_{i=1}^{\infty}$ of X such that $K_i \subseteq K_{i+1}^{\circ}$ and $X = \bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} K_i$.

The condition of compact exhaustability is satisfied under relatively mild hypotheses.

Proposition 1.19. Let X be a topological space. If X is locally Euclidean, Hausdorff, and second countable, X admits an exhaustion by compact subsets.

Proof. We first note that since X is locally Euclidean, it admits a basis $\mathcal{B}$ of open subsets having compact closure: for each chart (U, ϕ) we can take some $x \in U$ and set the image of the chart to be centered at x homeomorphic onto the open unit ball by Proposition 1.5 and produce a countable basis of the ball by smaller balls wich have compact closure. By taking preimages, we can consider the countable union of countable balls with compact closures inducing the respective property for each open of X.

Furthermore, since X is second countable, it is covered – up to a choice of bijection of the countable indexing set with the natural numbers – by countably many sets $\{U_i\}_{i=1}^{\infty}$ with compact closure. Suppose $K_1 = \overline{U_1}$. We proceed by induction and suppose that there are compact sets $K_1, \ldots, K_m$ such that $U_i \subseteq K_i$ for each i and $K_i \subseteq K_{i+1}^{\circ}$ for $2 \leq i \leq m-1$. Since K_m is compact, there is some $N_m \geq m+1$ large such that $K_m \subseteq U_1 \cup \cdots \cup U_{N_m}$. If $K_{m+1} = \overline{U_1} \cup \cdots \cup \overline{U_{N_m}}$ then K_{m+1} is closed and thus compact with interior containing K_m giving the claim. ∎

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